DRAFT: sampler wording and title are not final. Contact: pypteltd@gmail.com

SAMPLE

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Maths puzzles for early finishers

Early Finisher Puzzles

Primary 1

Sampler for teachers: 4 pages

What they are

Single-page maths puzzles for Primary 1 pupils. Each page stands alone and is **self-checking**: a boxed strip at the foot tells the pupil how to check the work. Most pages use a code word: the pupil looks up each answer in a code table, and the letters, written in order, spell a word. The check shows that something is wrong; it does not give the answer.

Who they are for

Pupils who finish their work early and can then work alone, with no help to start. For teachers: no marking is needed, and you can hand out one page or keep a tray of pages in the classroom.

How to use a page in 10 seconds

1. Photocopy one page. A4, 100%, one side.
2. Hand it to the pupil who has finished.
3. The pupil does the page and uses the Check it strip.

To spot-check, look only at the strip: does the word make sense?

★ One star

One skill, as usually taught. A good first page for most pupils.

Sample: page 2, Count the Crowd.

★★ Two stars

The same topics, with two steps or two clues to combine. More thinking, same format.

Sample: page 3, Which Two Items?

In this sampler

Page 2: a real one-star pupil page. **Page 3:** a real two-star pupil page. **Page 4:** the teacher page on how the check works, with the answer key entries for pages 2 and 3. The pages are black and white and copy cleanly. They are taken unchanged from the full booklets; a small SAMPLE line is added at the top.

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S1-01 (P1-25)

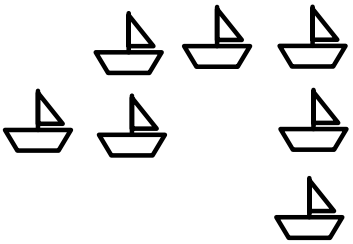
Count the Crowd

Name _____

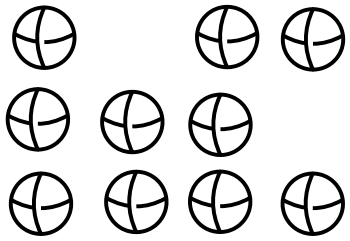
Topic: Counting a set and comparing two sets

Count each set.
Match the pictures with lines.
Use the code table.

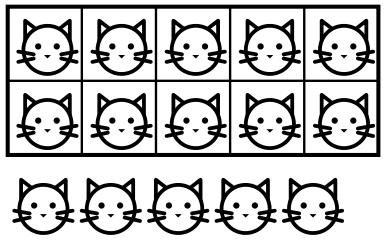
1 How many boats?



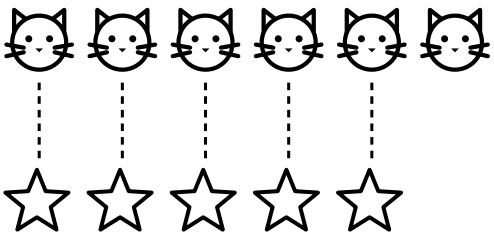
2 How many balls?



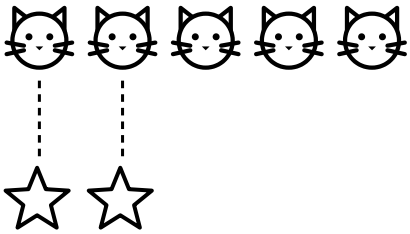
3 How many cats?



4 How many more cats than stars?



5 How many fewer stars than cats?



Code table

1 = T	3 = H	5 = Y	6 = F	7 = C	8 = Q
10 = L	15 = O				

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-13 (P1-27)

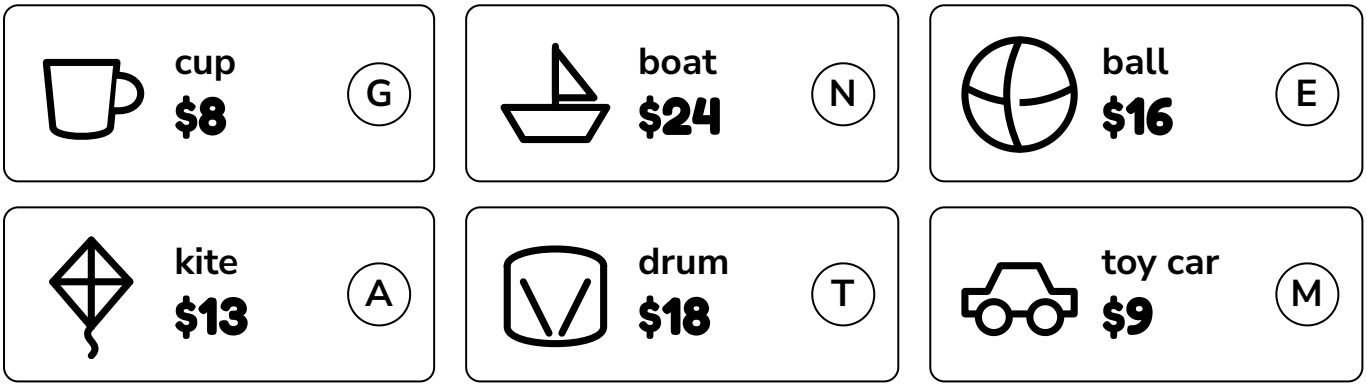
Which Two Items?

★★ Name _____

Topic: Money in dollars: which two things cost exactly the amount paid

Each person buys 2 things.
Find which 2 things.
Write their letters, cheaper first.

The shop sells 6 things.



1. Jenny pays $22 for 2 things. $ ☐ + $ ☐ letters ☐☐

2. Aisha pays $32 for 2 things. $ ☐ + $ ☐ letters ☐☐

3. Lily pays $34 for 2 things. $ ☐ + $ ☐ letters ☐☐

Check it. Read your six letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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Teacher page SAMPLE

How the check works

Every page ends with a boxed strip, **Check it**, that tells the pupil what to do. The check shows that something is wrong. It does not give the answer, and it asks the pupil to see whether the answer makes sense. Marking is not needed: to spot-check, look only at the strip.

Code word (pages 2 and 3). Each answer is looked up in the code table on the page, and the letters, written in order, spell a word. The strip gives no hint of the word. Each word can be spelt from its letters in one way only, so answers in the wrong boxes never make another word. Every answer box and letter box must be filled: a box left blank gives no letter, and the check cannot see it.

If the check fails. The pupil goes back, looks for the slip, and asks a friend or you if still stuck.

Other checks in the booklets. Colour by code (the pupil counts the parts of each colour), a route that must reach FINISH through a stated number of boxes, a loop whose numbers must match all the way round, and a total that must match the one in the strip.

How the checks were tested. A script tried every single wrong answer and every wrong arrangement on every page. Each check rejected at least 95% of them; a wrong answer that spells any of about 129 000 English words counts as not rejected. Two wrong answers at once were not all tested.

Photocopying. Pages are black and white with solid lines. Print on A4 at 100% (actual size); each page is one side only.

Answer key entries for pages 2 and 3 (extract from the teacher answer key)

S1-01 (P1-25) Count the Crowd 1 star

Topic: Counting a set and comparing two sets

Syllabus outcomes: Whole Numbers 1.1, Whole Numbers 1.4. Notes on the tag: 1.1, 1.4 (counting to tell the number of objects in a given set; comparing the number of objects in two sets)
Puzzle type: Code-breaker (counting). How the pupil checks: Code word (5 letters).
Answers: 1) 7, 2) 10, 3) 10 + 5 = 15, 4) 6 - 5 = 1 more, 5) 5 - 2 = 3 fewer
Check result: Code word: CLOTH
Teacher note: Three counting items (the third is a full ten frame and some more) and two comparing items. In the comparing items every picture in the shorter row is joined by a line to one in the longer row; the pictures with no line are the answer to how many more or how many fewer. Pictures are objects, never bare dots. Every set is small; the ten frame item is a full ten and some more.

S2-13 (P1-27) Which Two Items? 2 stars

Topic: Money in dollars: which two things cost exactly the amount paid

Syllabus outcomes: Money 1.1, Addition and Subtraction 2.5 (problem solving). Notes on the tag: Money 1.1 (dollars up to $100), 2.5 (adding within 100); guess and check, problem solving
Puzzle type: Logic (price board). How the pupil checks: The letters of the two things each buyer pays for, cheaper thing first, spell a word (6 letters).
Answers: Jenny pays $22: toy car $9 (M) and kite $13 (A); Aisha pays $32: cup $8 (G) and boat $24 (N); Lily pays $34: ball $16 (E) and drum $18 (T)
Check result: Letters in order: MAGNET
Teacher note: Six things with prices in dollars. Each of three people pays an exact amount for two of them; for each amount only one pair of things works, and the three pairs use all six things. The pupil tries pairs (guess and check), then writes the letter of the cheaper thing and then the dearer one. The six letters have exactly one arrangement that is a word, and every single wrong pair was tested: none spells a word. Prices are whole dollars within $100.

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